

Arts & Entertainment

35 words · Arts & Entertainment

NOUNS

plot

the sequence of events that make up a story in a book, film, or play

I won't tell you the plot, but the ending completely surprised me.

audience

the group of people watching or listening to a performance

The audience clapped for almost five minutes after the final scene.

costume

clothing worn to represent a character, period, or theme

The actors' costumes were incredibly detailed, right down to the buttons.

earworm

a catchy tune that keeps repeating in your head

That jingle is such an earworm. I've been humming it all morning.

review

a piece of writing that gives an opinion on the quality of something such as a book or film

The film got glowing reviews, so we decided to watch it that night.

exhibition

a public display of works of art or interesting objects

There's a new exhibition of Impressionist paintings at the gallery this month.

sequel

a book, film, or show that continues the story of an earlier one

The sequel wasn't as good as the original, in my opinion.

kitsch

art, objects, or design seen as tasteless or overly sentimental but enjoyable anyway

The hotel lobby is full of 1970s kitsch, all lava lamps and shag carpets.

ADJECTIVES

catchy

(of a tune) easy to remember and pleasant to hear

That song is so catchy that it's been stuck in my head all day.

underrated

not appreciated or valued as much as it deserves

That album is so underrated; hardly anyone I know has even heard it.

subjective

based on personal opinion rather than fact

Beauty is completely subjective; what I love, you might hate.

gripping

so exciting or interesting that it holds your attention completely

It's a gripping crime novel that I read in a single sitting.

overrated

praised or valued more than it deserves

Honestly, I thought the film was overrated.

dubbed

(of a film or show) having the original dialogue replaced with a translated soundtrack

I prefer subtitles to dubbed versions; the acting feels more authentic.

highbrow

relating to culture regarded as serious, sophisticated, or intellectual

The festival mixes highbrow theatre with more popular entertainment.

pretentious

trying to appear more intelligent, artistic, or important than is genuinely the case

Some critics found the film pretentious, full of symbolism nobody could explain.

lowbrow

unsophisticated or lacking in intellectual or artistic value

Critics dismissed the show as lowbrow, but audiences loved it.

VERBS

rehearse

to practise a performance before doing it in public

The choir rehearses every Wednesday evening before the concert.

recommend

to suggest that someone would enjoy or benefit from something

Can you recommend a good podcast for the drive?

host

to organise an event and welcome the guests

My sister is hosting the family get-together this year.

binge-watch

to get through many episodes of a TV series in one sitting

We binge-watched the entire series over the weekend.

PHRASAL VERBS

put down

to stop holding or reading something, especially a book

It was such a good book that I couldn't put it down.

dress up

to wear special, formal, or costume clothing for an occasion

We're dressing up as characters from our favourite film, actually.

date back to

to have existed since a particular time in the past

The tradition dates back to the Middle Ages.

COLLOCATIONS

turning point

a moment when an important or lasting change happens

The invention of the printing press was a turning point in European history.

guilty pleasure

something enjoyed despite a slight sense of embarrassment about liking it

Reality TV is my guilty pleasure. I'd never admit it at work.

plot twist

an unexpected change in the direction of a story

Nobody saw that plot twist coming, and it changed everything.

oral tradition

knowledge, stories, or customs passed from one generation to the next by speech rather than in writing

Long before it was written down, the myth survived for centuries through oral tradition.

bygone era

a period of time in the past, often viewed with nostalgia

The old cinema feels like a relic of a bygone era.

IDIOMS

steal the show

to attract the most attention and praise in a performance

The supporting actor completely stole the show.

strike a chord

to produce a strong feeling of emotion or sympathy

The lyrics really struck a chord with me after the breakup.

raise a glass

to make a toast to someone or something

Let's raise a glass first, to forty wonderful years together.

SET PHRASES

each to their own

used to say that people are entitled to their own tastes or opinions

I don't get the appeal of opera myself, but each to their own.

no spoilers

a request not to reveal important plot details in advance

No spoilers, please. I haven't finished the series yet!

MODERN SLANG

gig

a live music performance

We saw a great gig at that little venue in town last night.